

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

more money. There are plenty of other volumes promising to make you rich, and you'll usually find them on bestseller lists. My promise is a more modest but, in my opinion, infinitely more valuable one. I want to help you to fix your relationship with money and, once you do that, I think a lot of other things will change for you. That's certainly what happened for me.

I started my own personal financial journey from a place of quite severe self-loathing. I had reached a complete breaking point, having neglected my relationship with money and financial wellbeing for over a decade. I was twenty-nine, a mother to two small children, and more than £27,000 in the red. Not only was my debt large, but it was spread across multiple accounts – credit cards, store cards and an overdraft – meaning that I had repayments pinging out of my accounts at all times of the month. Often, direct debits would be returned, complicating things even further, and it was only a matter of time before one or more of my spinning financial plates would crash to the ground. I was anxious, not sleeping well, preoccupied and irritable. I was aggressively ambitious at work, to the point where I was probably not a very good colleague, because I felt compelled to pursue financial success above everything else, so that I could fund a lifestyle that I believed would finally make me happy. I assumed that the world in which I was a successful, thin, beautiful and fulfilled person could be built out of material things, and material things cost money. At the same time, I was failing miserably